

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

This article appeared on a website:

Adaptability quotient

We are all familiar with IQ (intelligence quotient) and EQ (emotional quotient). Adding to these two Qs is a new one: AQ. AQ stands for adaptability quotient. It is the ability to learn, adjust, and change to new situations or circumstances. People with high AQ can work in a variety of environments and succeed in times of change and uncertainty.

Technology is changing our world every day and requires us to learn and re-invent ourselves again and again, faster and faster. The good news is that AQ is something we can train and develop:

Change your routine

Seek or create opportunities for change. Doing the same thing is comfortable, but we can easily become too lazy to leave our comfort zone. Instead of staying home for the weekend again, reconnect with your old friends. Rather than robotically walking down the same street, take different paths.

Keep learning

Learn a new skill every now and then. Learning requires active thinking, careful planning, constant adjustment and strong commitment. Learning anything new will train you to be always up for challenges.

Be curious and observant

Watch and learn from others. They can be successful people you read about in books or your friends and family. Pay attention to how and why people make important decisions in life. The more you think from different people's perspectives, the more open you will be to different ideas.

Your school is organising a workshop on adaptability quotient (AQ). Your group is brainstorming some ideas for the workshop. You may want to talk about:

- why being adaptable is becoming more important nowadays
- whether being adaptable is more important than being intelligent
- whether it is possible to teach adaptability
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Do you like trying new things?
2. Can you adapt to new environments quickly?
3. Do you think having new experiences is important?
4. Are Hong Kong students adaptable?
5. Are young people better at coping with change than older people?
6. Do you think change is always good?
7. Do you consider yourself a risk taker?
8. Why are some people more adaptable than others?